- Route templates define the structure of known URLs in your application. They’re strings with placeholders for variables that can contain optional values and map to endpoint handlers. You should think about your routes carefully, as they’re the public surface of your application.
- Route parameters are variable values extracted from a request’s URL. You can use route parameters to map multiple URLs to the same endpoint and to extract the variable value from the URL automatically.
- Route parameters can be optional and can use default values when a value is missing. You should use optional and default parameters sparingly, as they can make your APIs harder to understand, but they can be useful in some cases. Optional parameters must be the last segment of a route.
- Route parameters can have constraints that restrict the possible values allowed. If a route parameter doesn’t match its constraints, the route isn’t considered to be a match. This approach can help you disambiguate between two similar routes, but you shouldn’t use constraints for validation.
- Use a catch-all parameter to capture the remainder of a URL into a route value. Unlike standard route parameters, catch-all parameters can include slashes (/) in the captured values.
- You can use the routing infrastructure to generate URLs for your application. This approach ensures that all your links remain correct if you change your endpoint’s route templates.